

Blog Troubleshooting Guide - MoreThanOneWay.org

Common Issues & Solutions

This guide covers the most common problems you might encounter with your blog and how to fix them.

Build & Deployment Issues

✗ "npm run build" fails with syntax error

Error looks like:

```
SyntaxError: Unexpected token
```

Cause: JavaScript syntax error in posts.js (usually a missing comma or bracket)

Solution:

1. Check for missing commas:

```
javascript
```

```
// ✗ WRONG (missing comma after first post)
```

```
{  
  id: 1,  
  title: "Post 1",  
  content: `...`  
}  
{ // ← Error! Missing comma above  
  id: 2,  
  title: "Post 2"  
}
```

```
// ✓ CORRECT
```

```
{  
  id: 1,  
  title: "Post 1",  
  content: `...`  
}, // ← Comma here!  
{  
  id: 2,  
  title: "Post 2"  
}
```

2. Check for unclosed backticks:

javascript

//  *WRONG*

content: `

 This is my content

// Missing closing backtick!

//  *CORRECT*

content: `

 This is my content

`

3. Check for unclosed brackets:

javascript

//  *WRONG*

{

 id: 1,

 title: "Post"

// Missing closing brace!

//  *CORRECT*

{

 id: 1,

 title: "Post"

}

Use a code editor (VS Code, Notepad++) to highlight matching brackets!

"Module not found" error

Error looks like:

Failed to resolve import "../posts" from "src/BlogPage.jsx"

Cause: Missing file in src folder

Solution:

1. Check that ALL these files exist in your `src` folder:
 - BlogPage.jsx

- BlogPost.jsx
- BlogCard.jsx
- posts.js

2. Check file names are EXACTLY:

- ☒ BlogPage.jsx (capital B, capital P)
- ☒ NOT Blogpage.jsx or blogpage.jsx

3. Check that posts.js has the export statement at bottom:

```
javascript

export const posts = [
  // ... your posts
];
```

☒ Deploy succeeds but changes don't appear

Cause: Browser cache or GitHub Pages deployment delay

Solution:

1. **Wait 2-3 minutes** after `npm run deploy` finishes
2. **Hard refresh browser:**
 - Windows: `Ctrl + Shift + R`
 - Mac: `Cmd + Shift + R`
3. **Try incognito/private window**
4. **Check GitHub Actions:**
 - Go to your GitHub repo
 - Click "Actions" tab
 - Make sure gh-pages deployment finished

Display Issues

☒ Post not showing up on blog page

Symptoms: New post doesn't appear in blog listing

Solution:

1. Check posts.js array:

javascript

```
export const posts = [
  {
    id: 1,
    // ... post 1
  },
  {
    id: 2,
    // ... YOUR NEW POST (is it here?)
  }
];
```

2. Make sure post has all required fields:

javascript

```
{
  id: 2,           //  Required
  title: "...",    //  Required
  slug: "...",     //  Required
  date: "...",     //  Required
  category: "...", //  Required
  excerpt: "...",  //  Required
  readTime: "...", //  Required
  content: `...`   //  Required
}
```

3. Check category name matches exactly:

-  "Career" or "Academics" or "Mental Health"
-  NOT "career" or "mental health" (case matters!)

4. Rebuild and test:

bash

```
npm run build
npm run dev
```

Featured post not displaying correctly

Symptoms: Featured post looks the same as regular posts

Solution:

1. Check only ONE post has `featured: true`:

```
javascript

{
  id: 1,
  featured: true, //  Only this one
  // ...
},
{
  id: 2,
  featured: false, // All others should be false
  // ...
}
```

2. Featured posts only show when:

- No category filter is selected
- No search term is entered

3. Test by:

- Going to /blog (main page)
- Make sure "All Posts" is selected
- Featured post should be large card at top

✗ Category colors not showing

Symptoms: Category tags are all the same color

Solution:

1. Check category name matches EXACTLY:

```
javascript
```

//  **CORRECT** (these have colors)

category: "Career" // Blue

category: "Academics" // Green

category: "Mental Health" // Purple

//  **WRONG** (no color defined)

category: "career"

category: "Career Advice"

category: "academics"

2. To add a new category color:

Edit `BlogCard.jsx`, find this section:

```
javascript
```

```
className={`
  text-xs font-medium px-3 py-1 rounded-full
  ${post.category === 'Career' ? 'bg-blue-100 text-blue-700' : ''}
  ${post.category === 'Academics' ? 'bg-green-100 text-green-700' : ''}
  ${post.category === 'Mental Health' ? 'bg-purple-100 text-purple-700' : ''}
`}
```

Add your new category:

```
javascript
```

```
${post.category === 'Your New Category' ? 'bg-orange-100 text-orange-700' : ''}
```

Do the same in `BlogPost.jsx`!

Search not working

Symptoms: Typing in search bar doesn't filter posts

Solution:

1. Check that posts have tags:

```
javascript
```

```
{
  id: 1,
  tags: ["keyword1", "keyword2"], //  Has tags
  // ...
}
```

2. Search looks in:

- Post title
- Post excerpt
- Post tags

3. Test search by:

- Typing exact words from title
- Typing words from tags array

Content Issues

Markdown not rendering

Symptoms: Seeing markdown syntax instead of formatted text

Example:

```
# This should be a heading
**This should be bold**
```

Solution:

1. Check backticks are correct:

```
javascript
```

//  CORRECT

```
content: `
```

```
# Heading
```

```
**Bold text**
```

```
`
```

//  WRONG (using quotes instead of backticks)

```
content: "
```

```
# Heading
```

```
**Bold text**
```

```
"
```

2. Make sure react-markdown is installed:

```
bash
```

```
npm install react-markdown remark-gfm
```

3. Check imports in BlogPost.jsx:

```
javascript
```

```
import ReactMarkdown from 'react-markdown';
```

```
import remarkGfm from 'remark-gfm';
```

Internal links not working

Symptoms: Clicking link in blog post doesn't navigate

Solution:

1. Check link format:

```
markdown
```

 CORRECT

```
[Crisis Resources](/crisis)
```

```
[Study Help](/study-resources)
```

 WRONG

```
[Crisis Resources](crisis) ← Missing leading slash
```

```
[Study Help](https://morethanoneway.org/study-resources) ← Full URL won't work
```

2. Check page name mapping in BlogPost.jsx:

The `handleInternalLink` function maps URLs to page names:

```
javascript

const pageMap = {
  '/study-resources': 'study-resources',
  '/crisis': 'crisis',
  // ... etc
};
```

If you added a new page, add it here!

3. Available internal links:

- `/study-resources`
- `/crisis`
- `/stories`
- `/find-internships`
- `/resume-builder`
- `/search-guide`
- `/interview-prep`
- `/youre-not-alone`
- `/job-tools`
- `/tracker`

✖ Images not loading

Symptoms: Broken image icon or missing images

Solution:

1. Check image is in public folder:

```
public/
images/
blog/
  your-image.jpg ← Image must be here!
```

2. Check path format:

```
javascript
```

```
//  CORRECT
```

```
image: "/images/blog/my-image.jpg"
```

```
//  WRONG
```

```
image: "./images/blog/my-image.jpg" ← No leading dot
```

```
image: "images/blog/my-image.jpg" ← Missing leading slash
```

```
image: "/src/images/blog/my-image.jpg" ← Wrong folder
```

3. Check file extension matches:

- File is `photo.jpg` → Use `.jpg` in path
- File is `photo.png` → Use `.png` in path
- Case-sensitive on some servers!

4. Test locally:

```
bash
```

```
npm run dev
```

```
# Visit http://localhost:5173/blog
```

Navigation Issues

Blog link not appearing in menu

Symptoms: Can't find Blog in navigation dropdown

Solution:

1. Check App.jsx has blog in resourcesItems:

```
javascript
```

```
const resourcesItems = [  
  { page: 'resources', label: 'Career Resources', icon: <Briefcase /> },  
  { page: 'blog', label: 'Blog', icon: <Newspaper /> }, // ← Should be here  
  // ...  
];
```

2. Check Newspaper icon is imported:

```
javascript
```

```
import { Heart, MessageCircle, Newspaper, ... } from 'lucide-react';
```

3. Rebuild:

```
bash  
  
npm run build
```

✗ Clicking blog post does nothing

Symptoms: Clicking post card doesn't open the post

Solution:

1. Check App.jsx has selectedPostSlug state:

```
javascript  
  
const [selectedPostSlug, setSelectedPostSlug] = useState("");
```

2. Check BlogPage receives props:

```
javascript  
  
{currentPage === 'blog' && (  
  <BlogPage  
    setCurrentPage={setCurrentPage}  
    setSelectedPostSlug={setSelectedPostSlug} // ← Must have this  
  />  
)}
```

3. Check BlogCard receives props: In `BlogPage.jsx`:

```
javascript  
  
<BlogCard  
  post={post}  
  setCurrentPage={setCurrentPage}  
  setSelectedPostSlug={setSelectedPostSlug} // ← Must pass this  
>
```

✗ Back button doesn't work

Symptoms: "Back to Blog" button does nothing

Solution:

1. Check BlogPost.jsx has setCurrentPage:

```
javascript

<button
  onClick={() => setCurrentPage('blog')} // ← Should be 'blog' not '/blog'
  // ...
>
  Back to Blog
</button>
```

2. Make sure BlogPost receives setCurrentPage prop: In `App.jsx`:

```
javascript

{currentPage === 'blog-post' && (
  <BlogPost
    setCurrentPage={setCurrentPage} // ← Must have this
    selectedPostSlug={selectedPostSlug}
    setSelectedPostSlug={setSelectedPostSlug}
  />
)}
```

Performance Issues

⚠ Blog page loads slowly

Symptoms: Blog takes several seconds to load

Solutions:

1. Optimize images:

- Use compressed JPGs (not huge PNGs)
- Resize images to max 1200px wide
- Use tools like TinyPNG or Squoosh

2. Reduce post count:

- If you have 50+ posts, consider pagination
- Archive old posts

3. Check for large markdown content:

- Very long posts (5000+ words) can slow rendering

- Consider breaking into multiple posts
-

Debugging Tips

How to Find Errors

1. Check Browser Console:

- Press `F12` (Windows) or `Cmd+Option+I` (Mac)
- Click "Console" tab
- Look for red error messages
- Read the error carefully - it usually tells you what's wrong!

2. Check Terminal Output: When running `npm run build` or `npm run dev`:

- Read error messages carefully
- Note the file name and line number
- Error usually tells you exactly what to fix

3. Test Locally First:

```
bash  
  
npm run dev
```

- Errors show immediately
- Faster than deploying
- Can experiment safely

4. Use Process of Elimination:

- Comment out your new post
- Does blog work now?
- If yes → problem is in your new post
- If no → problem is elsewhere

5. Compare to Working Example:

- Look at existing posts in `posts.js`
- Copy structure exactly

- Change content but keep format
-

Emergency Fixes

Site is broken after deployment

Quick fix:

1. Revert to last working version:

```
bash

git log # Find last working commit
git revert <commit-hash>
npm run build
npm run deploy
```

2. Or restore backup:

- Go to your GitHub repo
- Download previous version of posts.js
- Replace your broken version
- Redeploy

Prevention:

- Always test with `npm run dev` before deploying
 - Keep backups of posts.js
-

Accidentally deleted all posts

Solution:

1. Check Git history:

```
bash

git checkout HEAD~1 src/posts.js # Restore from 1 commit ago
```

2. Or download from GitHub:

- Go to your repo
- Find posts.js
- Click "History"

- Download previous version

Prevention:

- Commit changes before editing
 - Keep backup copy of posts.js
-

Getting More Help

Before Asking for Help

Provide this information:

- What you were trying to do
- What you expected to happen
- What actually happened
- Error messages (exact text)
- Browser and operating system

Resources

- **Technical documentation:** BLOG_README.md
- **Writing guide:** BLOG_WRITING_GUIDE.md
- **Project plan:** BLOG_MASTER_PLAN.md

Contact

Email: support@morethanoneway.org

Preventive Maintenance

Best Practices

DO:

- Test locally before deploying
- Keep backups of posts.js
- Commit changes to Git regularly
- Use consistent formatting
- Proofread before publishing

DON'T:

- Edit live site files directly
- Skip testing step
- Make multiple changes at once
- Delete files without backups

Common Warnings (Safe to Ignore)

⚠ "Compiled with warnings"

If you see:

Compiled with warnings.

./src/BlogPage.jsx

Line 42: React Hook useEffect has a missing dependency

This is usually safe to ignore if your site works correctly.

These are suggestions, not errors.

Still Having Issues?

Try this debugging checklist:

- ☐ Ran `npm install` (dependencies installed)?
- ☐ All 4 blog files in src folder?
- ☐ posts.js has proper syntax (no missing commas)?
- ☐ Tested with `npm run dev` first?
- ☐ Cleared browser cache (Ctrl+Shift+R)?
- ☐ Waited 2-3 minutes after deploy?
- ☐ Checked browser console for errors (F12)?
- ☐ Compared your code to working examples?

If you've checked all of these and still have issues, email support@morethanoneway.org with:

- What you're trying to do
- Error message (exact text)
- Screenshot if applicable

Most issues are simple syntax errors - you've got this! 🛠

